

C12 TALENT RECRUITMENT AND WORKFORCE ACTION PLANS | O (MAX : 3 PT)

Intent : Promote employee engagement and belonging through an assessment of workforce demographics, creation of an action plan to improve engagement and belonging outcomes, implementation of support systems for employees, and implementation of fair hiring and pay practices.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to evaluate their current workforce demographics and develop an action plan to address employee engagement and belonging; implement support systems for employees including non-discrimination policies and training, employee resource groups, and dedicated leadership support; and implement fair and transparent hiring and pay practices.

Issue : Global companies in the top quartile for racial and ethnic diversity or gender diversity in executive leadership are 36% or 25% more likely to have financial returns above their national industry medians, respectively.¹ Beyond executive leadership, every 1% rise in ethnic or gender diversity in the U.S. workforce corresponds to a 9% and 3% rise in revenue, respectively.² Despite these performance benefits for organizations, some populations still face barriers to career advancement. In the United Kingdom for example, women's compensation is about 13% less than men's³ and 35% of LGBTQ+ employees hide that they are LGBTQ+ in feature of discrimination.⁴ In other industrialized countries, 50-70% of persons with disabilities of working age are unemployed.⁵

Solutions : Workforce representation accounts for multiple demographic factors including gender, age, race, ethnicity, socioeconomic status, disability, and more.⁶ Addressing workforce representation is complex and touches upon all of an organization's operations, including hiring practices, determination of compensation and wages, workplace culture and organizational structure. Organizations that seek to hire individuals with different backgrounds and experiences and that espouse fair treatment toward all individuals in their workforce through measurable actions drive both profit and positive culture by attracting and retaining top talent and driving innovation.²

PART 1 CREATE WORKFORCE ASSESSMENT, ENGAGEMENT AND BELONGING PLAN (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization meets the following requirements:

- a. An assessment of the project or organization's current workforce demographics is conducted utilizing at least four of the following:
 1. Gender (assigned, identity and/or expression).
 2. Sexual orientation.
 3. Race and ethnicity.
 4. Age.
 5. Socioeconomic background.
 6. Disability.
 7. Other metric(s) as identified by the project or organization.
- b. A workforce engagement and belonging plan is established and meets the following requirements:
 1. Identifies strategies to help all employees feel accepted, valued and included, considering findings from the demographic assessment.
 2. Tracks progress toward implementing those strategies on an annual basis.
 3. Publicly summarizes annual progress (e.g., on company website, in annual report).

PART 2 IMPLEMENT WORKFORCE SUPPORT SYSTEMS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization meets the following requirements:

- a. Implements a comprehensive non-discrimination policy that includes the following:
 1. Reporting protocol that allows occupants to anonymously report observed or experienced discrimination, resulting in a review by a third party and/or internal human resource professional or other ethics or compliance professional with the offending individual to mitigate future incidents.
 2. Penalties for retaliating against or falsifying reports of bias.
- b. Annual trainings available to all employees that include the following topics:
 1. The benefits having a workforce comprised of people with different backgrounds.
 2. Preventing, identifying and navigating observed or experienced discrimination.
 3. Preventing, identifying and reducing bias.
- c. Provides employees with resources (e.g., budget, meeting space, information, access to external support groups) to establish employee resource groups (ERGs) that are focused on fostering engagement and belonging within the workforce.
- d. Has at least one dedicated senior-level employee whose primary responsibility is to plan and oversee strategies that promote workforce engagement and belonging. The individual must have a dedicated budget and be employed at the executive (C-Suite) level or report directly to a member of the executive (C-Suite) team.¹

PART 3 IMPLEMENT FAIR HIRING AND PAY PRACTICES (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization meets the following requirements:

- a. Implements a hiring policy that:
 - 1. Bans the request of salary history.
 - 2. Requires blind resume reviews (i.e., information is removed that could indicate race/ethnicity, gender and socioeconomic background, including, at minimum, name and home address).
 - 3. Establishes hiring evaluation protocols with transparent performance standards (e.g., communicating job requirements clearly and establishing fair and consistent performance objectives for all employees, demonstrating transparency and clear expectations for every role).
 - 4. Establishes goals for hiring candidates with varied backgrounds, perspectives and experiences, which hiring managers are evaluated at performance reviews at least annually.
 - 5. Establishes having varied backgrounds, perspectives and experiences represented in mid-and executive-level leadership positions and/or on the board of directors.
- b. Implements a compensation policy that is made available to all employees and includes at least three of the following:
 - 1. Determination of compensation independent of gender identity, sexual orientation, race and ethnicity, age, disability status, or religion.
 - 2. Provision of compensation that meets basic needs and provides some discretionary income to all employees.
 - 3. Compensation transparency (e.g., making employee compensation figures visible either internally, externally or both) or published compensation ranges for all titles.⁷⁻⁹
 - 4. A blind annual evaluation of all employee compensation to assess and improve fair compensation distribution.
 - 5. Annual trainings or workshops for employees on compensation and contract negotiation.

REFERENCES

- 1. Hunt D, Prince S, Dixon-Fyle S, Dolan K. Diversity Wins: How inclusion matters. 2020. [Reference](#)
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- 3. Office for National Statistics. Gender Pay Gap in the UK: 2024. Accessed April 14, 2025. [Reference](#)
- 4. Bachmann CL, Gooch B. LGBT in Britain - Work Report.; 2018. Accessed April 14 2025. [Reference](#)
- 5. Disability and Employment Fact Sheet 1. Accessed April 14 2025. [Reference](#)
- 6. The B Team. The Diversity Paradox: Capturing the Value of Difference by Looking Beyond the Numbers. The B Team; 2015. [Reference](#)
- 7. Korn Ferry. How to Achieve Pay Equity and Transform Your Workplace. 2024. Accessed April 14 2025. [Reference](#)
- 8. Mayer, K. One Benefit of Pay Transparency? More Productive Workers. 2023. Accessed April 14 2025. [Reference](#)
- 9. Comport. The Link Between Compensation and Diversity Strategies for Creating Inclusive Pay Practices. 2023. Accessed April 14 2025. [Reference](#)